

KIQ 1.4 — Patent IPC Occurrence Insight Recap

Key Intelligence Question (KIQ 1.4): What are the main strengths and weaknesses of METRO's digital ordering channels from a customer perspective?

Core Indicators: Positive/negative app-store review themes; complaints about usability or bugs; praise for convenience, speed, or product range.

Patent Corpus Used

A targeted patent corpus of approximately 250 recent patents (2022–2026) related to user interfaces, automated application testing, and digital store customer feedback loops was extracted from Espacenet.

Method Applied

IPC (International Patent Classification) occurrence analysis was conducted to identify the dominant technological sub-classes and structural development areas chosen by competitors.

Main Insights (Patent IPC Occurrence)

- G06Q30/06 (E-commerce and Digital Ordering): This IPC class heavily dominates the dataset, confirming massive structural R&D investments aimed at making digital checkout channels highly convenient and fast for the user.
- G06F11/36 (Software Testing and Bug Detection): High frequency of this technical class shows a competitive industry focus on building automated tools to eliminate crashes and usability bugs before they hit application stores.
- G06F3/048 (Graphical User Interfaces): Strong recurring presence indicates heavy technical optimization regarding interface convenience, menu responsiveness, and fluid product catalog presentation.

Strategic Interpretation

The patent distribution proves that industry players protect usability strengths primarily through software testing frameworks and advanced interface layouts. For METRO, keeping up with customer expectations requires securing proprietary methods that automate bug detection and enhance app catalog navigation speed.